Children acquire important life skills and values by observing and imitating grown- ups like parents or teachers. Can it be the other way round? Now, you are going to listen to the poem 'Once Upon a Time', where a parent wants to learn something from the son. Let's find out how.

Once upon a time, son
They used to laugh with their hearts
And laugh with their eyes:
But now they only **laugh with their teeth**
While their **ice-block-cold eyes**
Search behind my shadow.

There was a time indeed
They used to shake hands with their hearts
But that's gone, son
Now they shake hands without hearts
While their left hands search
My empty pockets.



"Feel at home!", "Come again":
They say, and when I come
Again and feel
At home, once, twice
There will be no thrice -
For then I find doors shut on me.

So I have learnt many things, son
I have learned to wear many faces
Like dresses – home face
Office face, street face, host face
Cocktail face, with all their **conforming smiles**
Like a fixed portrait smile.



And I have learned too
To laugh with only my teeth
And shake hands without my heart
I have also learned to say "Goodbye"
When I mean "**Good-riddance**":
To say "Glad to meet you"
Without being glad; and to say "It's been
Nice talking to you", after being bored.

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